W. Matthew Alampay Davis

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Department of Economics
Columbia University
New York, NY 10027

Education

Columbia University
Graduate School of Arts and Sciences
Ph.D Economics (2025, expected)

University of Oxford
Nuffield College
M.Phil Economics (2019)

New York University
Stern School of Business
B.S. Business & Political Economy (2015)

Research

Development economics · Environmental economics · Political economy

Large potential reduction in economic damages under UN mitigation targets, Nature
with Marshall Burke, Noah S. Diffenbaugh (2018)

Combining satellite imagery and machine learning to predict poverty, Science
with Neal Jean, Marshall Burke, Michael Xie, David B. Lobell, Stefano Ermon (2016)

Dissertation: Essays on development, the environment, and inequality
- Climate inequality (Job Market Paper)
- Environmental disruption, gendered violence, and cultural anti-persistence (*with* Tanushree Goyal)
- Political transition under environmental change
- The political economy of descriptive and substantive representations

Honors

Program for Economic Research Summer Fellowship (2024)
Columbia economics department award supporting summer research activities

Wueller Fourth-Year Pre-Dissertation Award (2023)
Columbia economics department runner-up best dissertation proposal

UC Berkeley and Sloan Foundation Diversity Fellowship (2022)
Awarded to five doctoral students in environmental and energy economics

Columbia GSAS Dean's Fellowship and Dissertation Fellowship (2019)
Full tuition and living stipend for up to six years of graduate study at Columbia

Oxford M.Phil economics top-scoring thesis (2019)
Department's first 'exceptional' (mark of 80+) thesis in at least four years

Nuffield College–Department of Economics Joint Studentship (2017)
Full tuition and living stipend for up to four years of graduate study at Oxford

Professional

Referee *Journal of Development Economics*

Teaching at Columbia University (nine semesters, 2020–2024)
- Consultant to all undergraduate and graduate thesis writers and research assistants
- ECON-4999 Senior honors thesis workshops (design and instruction)
- ECON-3412 Introduction to econometrics (TA)
- ECON-3211 Intermediate microeconomics (TA)
- ECON-2257 The global economy (TA)

Research
Associate: University of Oxford, Climate Econometrics Group (2017–2019)
Pre-doctoral assistant: Stanford University, Dept. of Earth System Science (2015–2017)

Background

Philippines (nationality), Indonesia (13 years), Vietnam (3 years)